

requirement, and so on. If the anti-virus came bundled with a fire-wall, it was given extra points. The automatic update feature was also given points if present.

In addition to these, we also noted if the vendor posted downloadable virus definition updates, the frequency of these updates, and also whether outbreak alerts were posted on the Web site. Telephone support and toll-free support was also awarded points. Last but not least, the price of the anti-virus (in the case of the paid ones) was also considered to decide our winner.

3.2.2 Free anti-virus software

3.2.2.1 Avira AntiVir PersonalEdition Classic

Avira AntiVir PersonalEdition Classic is a free anti-virus solution for home users. During the installation, the user has the option to install either one or both modules: AntiVir Guard and Shell Extension.

The AntiVir Guard is the on-access scanning element of the software. It runs in the background and monitors files during



The AntiVir interface is very simple and easy to navigate